
Paper 2, Option 2F.2: South Africa, 1948–94: from apartheid state to 'rainbow nation'

Overview

This option comprises a study in depth of South Africa during its transition from white minority rule to the free elections of 1994, a long, and at times, dramatic process in which South Africa changed from an apartheid state into a multi-racial democracy.

Students will gain an in-depth understanding of the creation and consolidation of the apartheid regime by the National Party and the response and methods used by their political opponents in the struggle to overthrow apartheid, as well social, economic and cultural changes that accompanied this process.

Key topics	Content
1 The response to apartheid, c1948–59	- Life in South Africa c1948: race, segregation and discrimination; urbanisation and industrialisation, including township life; rural society; Afrikaner culture and politics; the influence of Britain. - Reasons for the National Party victory 1948, including the impact of the Second World War, the growth of Afrikaner nationalism, and international pressures for change. - Codifying and implementing apartheid, 1948–59: strengthening the National Party; apartheid laws; pass laws and education; the Tomlinson Report and Bantustans; political suppression and the Treason Trial. - African nationalism, 1948–59: political opposition in 1948; the revival of the African National Congress (ANC); the Youth League and the Defiance Campaign; rural resistance; the Freedom Charter; the Pan-Africanist Congress (PAC).
2 Radicalisation of resistance and the consolidation of National Party power, 1960–68	- Resistance to apartheid and government reaction, 1960–61: peaceful protest; the Sharpeville Massacre and its significance; the banning of political parties and the state of emergency. - Creating a republic, 1960–61: Verwoerd's aims; the significance of Macmillan's 'wind of change' speech; a republic established, 1960–61; leaving the Commonwealth. - African nationalist radicalisation, 1961–68: moves to armed struggle; the ANC and Umkhonto we Sizwe; the PAC and Poqo; the Rivonia Trial and significance for Nelson Mandela; the impact of exile and imprisonment on the ANC and PAC.

Key topics	Content
3 Redefining resistance and challenges to National Party power, 1968–83	• Black Consciousness and the Soweto uprising, including: Steve Biko and the South African Students' Organisation (SASO); the mobilisation of school children; the Soweto Uprising, its significance and suppression. The impact of the death of Steve Biko 1977. • The ANC re-strengthened: decline in the early 70s; internal reorganisation and external legitimacy; the role of Oliver Tambo; the global anti-apartheid movement. • Domestic challenges to National Party power, 1974–83, including political unrest, problems in the Bantustans, National Party division and scandal, economic pressures and the cost of defence commitments. • External pressures on National Party power, 1974–83, including political change in southern Africa, international condemnation and calls for economic sanctions, cultural and sporting boycotts.
4 The end of apartheid and the creation of the 'rainbow nation', 1984–94	• Revolt in the townships, 1984–87: the United Democratic Front and grassroots organisation; protest strategies; communal and government violence; government suppression. • Reasons for Botha's decision to negotiate, 1985–89, including the failure of Botha's 'total strategy', economic problems and the impact of international isolation, the effect of the state of emergency. • Negotiation and compromise, 1989–91: de Klerk's new course; the significance of Mandela's release; the unbanning of political parties; the impact of unrest and violence; the dismantling of apartheid; CODESA 1991. • A new political settlement, 1992–94: CODESA negotiations; nationalist divisions and communal violence; constitutional agreement and elections; the Government of National Unity; international recognition.

Route G: Nationalism, dictatorship and democracy in twentieth-century Europe

Overview

Students taking Route G will study:

- *Paper 1, Option 1G: Germany and West Germany, 1918-89*

and **either**:

- *Paper 2, Option 2G.1: The rise and fall of fascism in Italy, c1911-46*

or:

- *Paper 2, Option 2G.2: Spain, 1930-78: republicanism, Francoism and the re-establishment of democracy.*

The options in Route G are linked by the themes of nationalism and dictatorship and their links with democracy. In Germany, Italy and Spain, a similar pattern of political change occurred that saw unstable democracies replaced by nationalist dictatorships, with significant impacts on the wider history of Europe, before returning to democratic forms of government.

Studying two different countries allows students to develop a greater understanding of the ways in which nationalism, dictatorship and then the transition to democracy were manifested, and of the contrasts and similarities in the nations studied (although students will not be required to answer comparative questions that link the breadth and the chosen depth option).